

Weighing only 54 kgs, ASIMO (Advanced Step in Innovative Mobility) was capable of communication with humans, running, walking, facial and environmental recognition, interacting with its environment and voice and posture recognition. Estimates in the same year showed that more than 700,000 robots were being used for industrial purposes around the world - and more than half of them in Japan.



AIBO

Artificial Intelligence Robot, or AIBO, was a robotic dog capable of interacting with humans which also gained popularity around this time. AIBO had several remarkable capabilities like responding to over 100 voice commands and talking in a tonal language, even though it was intended as a consumer market entertainment device.

Behold those who inherit the earth

To most of us, that statement might appear too exaggerated. While we are not claiming otherwise, it would be great if you could look around you and realise how much the world is already dependent on robots. For example, the Roomba automatic vacuum cleaner has sold millions of units, showing how willing we are to welcome robotic technology into our homes. These robots, by the way, are more sophisticated than they have ever been.

On the other side of the power spectrum, there are drones that can navigate the globe by themselves and perform dangerous aerial strikes while the human controller is seated in the safety of their office (or even asleep). In terms of brains, artificial intelligence programs have beaten the world's best at their own games and even learnt how to bluff. If anything, our current state of normalcy with robotics advancement indicates how smooth the transition will be to a world that is completely operated (and perhaps inhabited) by robots. 